Nepalese more than what India could do in the previous 30 years.

Under the “neighbourhood first” initiative, India was also prepared to walk the Prime Ministerial talk. There were clear signs of bridging India’s delivery deficit – the gap between promises and performance – in relation to the neigh-bours. The most obvious example was the ratification of the Land Boundary Agreement with Bangladesh, pending since 1974. The previous UPA-II regime had tried to achieve ratification but could not due to coalition compulsions. In the case of Nepal, hurdles in power trade were addressed, and moves were initiated to activate pending infrastructural projects. In Sri Lanka, about 45,360 houses were constructed/repaired by November 2016 in the Northern Province. This was part of a project undertaken in 2010 to build/repair 50,000 houses for the people uprooted during the ethnic conflict. The construction of the remaining 4000 houses in the Central and Uva provinces were completed subsequently. The reconstruction of rail and road links disrupted during the ethnic conflict has also been expedited.

India also moved to strengthen its economic and developmental cooperation with the neighbours. Problems of trade, especially the negative trade balance of the neighbouring countries, and investments started getting addressed. Bangladesh has officially registered Indian investment proposals exceeding US$3billion. During the April 2017 visit of Bangladesh Prime Minister Hasina Wajid, additional proposals of around US$10 billion in Indian investments were concluded. By 2019, under the umbrella of Modi’s “neighbourhood first” initiative, India had extended to Bangladesh a total of US$6.5 billion in concessional line of credit to cover infrastructure projects, special economic zones, health and medical care, and technical education. Nepal has been offered a US$1.75 billion line of credit for post-earthquake (April–May 2015) reconstruction. India’s commitment of developmental credit